The river town

A new road was planned for the spring, although the council had promised the same thing for eleven years. Some people said the town had not changed in a century, while others insisted that everything was different now. In the afternoon the light turned gold, and the old clock in the square ran four minutes late, as it always had.

Market days

A new road was planned for the spring, although the council had promised the same thing for eleven years. Most visitors came for the market, but a few stayed for the quiet streets and the long view of the hills. Children walked to school along the canal, counting boats and arguing about which one was the fastest.

The station master checked his watch twice, nodded at the driver, and the last train of the day pulled away. In the afternoon the light turned gold, and the old clock in the square ran four minutes late, as it always had. The station master checked his watch twice, nodded at the driver, and the last train of the day pulled away.